

Tyler Lindow

ENGINEERING MANAGER | DEVELOPER EXPERIENCE, PLATFORM, MERCHANT & PARTNER INTEGRATIONS

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SUMMARY

Led up to 9 engineers on Affirm's merchant and partner integrations and developer experience. Cut higher-transaction merchant outage detection from ~1 hour to under 5 minutes, led a merchant domain architecture review that reshaped the merchant org, and took Merchant Portal from ~99.7% to 99.9% availability with zero BFCM 2025 incidents. As founder of Beginner Work, built Tinker, an IDE for founders who want to get more technical. Targeting EM / Senior EM roles in developer experience, developer platforms, and partner integrations.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Founder and CEO | [Beginner Work Inc.](#)

📍 San Diego, CA | Mar 2026 – Jul 2026 (wound down before a raise)

Scope: Self-funded and set the thesis for Tinker, an IDE for founders who want to get more technical (essays capturing the founder's voice, a code editor, and an AI terminal generating diffs from that context), owning product, architecture, and GTM.

- **Product calls:** Shipped and open-sourced Tinker (github.com/beginner-work/tinker) as offline-first desktop and web apps, reaching 28 early users and 6 paying; built on Vercel, Stytych, GitHub, and Anthropic.
- **Discovery and fundraising:** Ran 87 conversations with founders, Tinker's early target users, and 5 with VCs across SF, NYC, and LA, then wound the company down rather than fund a GTM that wasn't compounding.

Software Engineering Manager, Merchant Engineering | [Affirm](#)

📍 San Diego, CA (Remote) | Mar 2025 – Feb 2026 (role eliminated)

Scope: Led the former developer-support team as Merchant Advocacy Engineering, a product engineering team alongside Design and Content: 9 software engineers at peak (2 Staff, 2 SWE II, 4 SWE I, 1 contractor). Owned Merchant Portal (React, TypeScript), the API-key and transaction-view surface for merchants on ecommerce platforms or direct API, with ~5K merchant sign-ups monthly.

- **Merchant domain architecture review:** Led a review that prompted Affirm to consolidate Merchant Risk and Merchant Advocacy under one EM, move former developer-support engineers into SRE, and add PM investment in direct merchant customer problems. The review set which team owns which merchant data across Partner APIs, Merchant Risk, and Merchant Data Platform and found Merchant Risk and Merchant Advocacy tightly coupled; aligned directors, principal, and staff engineers across merchant and partner wallets and presented to leadership in Q3 2025.
- **Intuit (announced February 2026):** Unblocked Affirm's launch as QuickBooks Payments' exclusive pay-over-time partner, stalled since November 2025 by a Merchant Portal onboarding bug; my team shipped 3 production fixes so the ramp began in early Q1 2026.
- **Merchant Portal reliability:** Raised Merchant Portal availability from ~99.7% to 99.9% in Q4 2025 (about two-thirds less downtime) with zero BFCM incidents by leading my team in moving its reads off Snowflake onto the merchant data platform's read-replica RPCs. Also fixed mislabeled 5xx codes and added Chronosphere dashboards and on-call alerting.
- **Incident Communications:** Ran Partner Engineering on-call across my team and ~10 Technical Account Management engineers. Built a web tool showing responders which enterprise merchants to email and when, plus Rootly automations prompting the same steps in incident Slack channels, raising enterprise merchant emails sent within the 15-minute SLA from near zero to ~70%.
- **Shift to building:** Raised the team's building time from ~10–20% to 50%+, freeing capacity for the SLA reporting handoff to SRE and the Intuit fix, by coaching Tier-2 support to self-serve in Snowflake and work directly with ecommerce platform teams, and by moving from sprints to Kanban.
- **People leadership:** Raised the performance bar by managing two underperformers, including a tech lead, through to exit and moving a third engineer to a better-fit team, deliberately reshaping the team from 9 engineers at peak to 6; that smaller team carried the shift to building, the Merchant Portal reliability work, and the Intuit fix.

Developer Support Engineering Manager, Partner Engineering | Affirm

📍 San Diego, CA (Remote) | Jul 2021 – Mar 2025

Scope: Managed a team that grew from 1 to 9 engineers (all SWEs by early 2025), building and running tooling for Affirm's merchant and partner integrations: per-merchant observability and alerting, Snowflake availability reporting for the Amazon partnership, and partner REST API and webhook support.

- **Observability:** Built per-merchant dashboards and alerting across ~20+ key accounts that cut detection time for outages at higher-transaction merchants from ~1 hour on average to under 5 minutes.
- **Amazon, flagship partner (21% of Affirm's GMV in FY2024):** Supported Amazon from before its August 2021 launch, then led my team's build of the Snowflake availability report that met Amazon's partnership requirements, later the baseline for the VP of Engineering's spring 2025 reliability sprint.
- **Merchant Portal SLA reports:** Acted as tech lead (no Staff engineers on the team yet) for an SLA reporting feature released in Merchant Portal in late 2024 to early 2025, letting Technical Account Managers share SLA reports directly with merchants and cutting monthly report turnaround from ~2 weeks to ~1 week. Wrote the tech spec every direct report built from.
- **Team building:** Owned interview rubrics and hiring decisions for 4 hires (2 developer support engineers and 2 SWEs, one in Poland) and integrated 5 engineers who joined through reorgs.
- **People development:** Delivered 2 promotions, including a junior engineer to intermediate in ~1 year who then moved into product engineering. Ran monthly career-growth reviews across the 9-engineer team; team engagement hit 9/10 (Affirm averaged 7.8–8.3).

Developer Support Engineer, Partner Engineering | Affirm

📍 San Francisco, CA (Hybrid) | Sep 2019 – Jul 2021

- **Merchant checkout integrations:** Primary technical liaison for 300+ SMB merchants; diagnosed JavaScript, REST API, and webhook defects in checkout / payment-method integrations on Shopify, Magento, WooCommerce, and Salesforce Commerce Cloud.
- **DevX feedback loop:** Built Snowflake ETL pipelines to cluster integration defects, turned developer feedback into platform fixes, and routed integration tickets to the ecommerce plugin team, cutting my team's ticket load 10–20% at first and ~50% by the time I left.

Earlier Experience

- Lead Software Engineering Immersive Resident, Galvanize / Hack Reactor (2019); Experience Development Specialist, The Tech Interactive (2017–2019); Design Code Build Instructor, Computer History Museum (2017–2018).

EDUCATION

- **University of California, San Diego** | B.S. NanoEngineering, Cum Laude (La Jolla, CA)
- **Northwestern University** | Learning Sciences graduate coursework (Evanston, IL)
- **Software engineering** | Hack Reactor Advanced Software Engineering Immersive; Deep Atlas Applied AI & ML residency

SKILLS & TOOLKITS

- **Technical Toolkit:** Python, JavaScript, TypeScript, React, Next.js, Node.js, Electron, Flask, Snowflake, SQL, Postgres, ETL Pipelines, REST APIs, Webhooks, CI/CD, Git/GitHub, observability (Chronosphere), Rootly, LLMs & agentic coding (Claude, Cursor)
- **Leadership & Management:** Performance management & promotions, org design / domain boundaries, mentorship, incident management
- **B2B Integrations & Operations:** Partner Engineering, merchant checkout integrations (Shopify, Magento, WooCommerce, SFCC)